Sri Lanka Institute of Information Technology

B.Sc. (Hons) Information Technology

Specialization in Information Technology

Employability Skills Development – IT3050

Mid-semester assignment

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Employability Readiness – Evidence Based Reflection

Introduction

This report contains an evidence based assessment of my current employability readiness based on my academic and professional experiences in the last two years. In order to evaluate my personal strengths and immediate growth areas as an employee, I will analyses a particular incident that has occurred during my undergraduate studies as well as align my current technological abilities with current industry standards.

By using this reflection as a reference point on how to evolve from being an Information Technology Student into becoming an industry ready employee, it will provide me with astrategic plan for transitioning into this new role.

1. Evidence Based Self Reflection

During my second year, I encountered an issue during a group project presentation. Although we had tested the system earlier, it failed to connect to the database during the live demo due to a configuration error.
As the person responsible for the demonstration, I quickly adapted by explaining the system using screenshots and recorded outputs while attempting to troubleshoot the issue. However, due to time constraints, the problem could not be fixed during the presentation.
We managed to complete the presentation, but the absence of a live demo reduced its effectiveness. This experience showed my ability to stay calm under pressure, but also highlighted the need for better preparation, especially backup planning and handling technical risks.

Self Assessment Ratings

Based on my behavior during the incident described above, I have rated myself on a scale of 1-5 across five core employability pillars

Skill	Rating (1-5)	Evidence from Incident	Behavioral Risk in a Corporate Setting
Accountability	4	I took responsibility for completing additional work when a teammate failed to deliver.	I may take on too much work, leading to stress and reduced efficiency.
Communication	3	I informed the team about the issue, but earlier communication could have prevented last-minute pressure.	Delayed communication may cause avoidable problems in a professional setting.
Teamwork	4	I supported the team by stepping in during a critical moment.	I may rely on reactive teamwork instead of proactive coordination.
Adaptability	4	I quickly adjusted to unexpected changes and learned new parts of the system.	Quick adaptation may lead to short-term fixes instead of long-term solutions.
Professional Discipline	3	I stayed committed and worked under pressure, but better time management could have avoided the situation.	Poor planning may affect consistency in a workplace.

Lecture Impact Analysis

One lecture that significantly influenced my thinking was about "Industry Expectations and Professional Behavior." A key idea discussed was that employees are expected to deliver consistent value, not just complete assigned tasks.
Before this lecture, I mainly focused on completing my individual responsibilities and achieving good academic results. However, I realized that in a professional environment, success depends on the overall team outcome and client satisfaction rather than individual performance alone.
This changed my perspective on the incident I experienced. I understood that simply finishing my part was not enough; I should have ensured better coordination within the team from the beginning. This insight has helped me recognize the importance of responsibility beyond assigned roles and the need for proactive communication in real-world projects.

2. Industry Alignment & Professional Judgment

I reviewed a job advertisement for a Junior Software Engineer position at a mid-sized software company. The role required several technical and soft skills.

I. Java and Spring Boot Development: I have experience working with Spring Boot for academic projects and understand the basics of building REST APIs.

II. Database Management (SQL): I am capable of writing queries, joins, and basic database operations.

III. Problem-Solving and Debugging: I can solve coding issues at a basic level and debug small applications

Ethical Scenario and Value Judgment

If I encounter a situation where a critical bug is identified close to the deadline and my Team Lead suggests ignoring it to avoid delays, I would choose to address the issue rather than ignore it.
Even though there may be pressure to deliver on time, releasing a system with a known critical defect can damage user trust and harm the company's reputation. I would communicate the issue clearly to the team and suggest possible solutions, such as fixing the bug quickly or informing stakeholders about the delay.
This decision reflects my values of integrity, responsibility, and commitment to quality. While it may be difficult to go against pressure, I believe maintaining professional standards is more important in the long run. However, I also recognize that I need to build more confidence to handle such situations effectively in a real workplace environment.

3. My Immediate Upgrade Plan

To improve my employability readiness over the next six months, I have identified the following actions:

I. Improve Technical Skills: I will complete at least one advanced Spring Boot project and deploy it using a cloud platform within the next three months.

II. Strengthen Problem-Solving Ability: I will solve a minimum of 100 coding problems on platforms like LeetCode over the next four months to improve my logical thinking and debugging skills.

III. Enhance Communication Skills: I will participate in at least one mock interview session per week and practice explaining technical concepts clearly to improve my confidence in professional communication.